



HUMANITAS
INSTITUTE

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Oak Grove Christian Academy
School Website: <https://www.oakgroveedenton.com/>

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Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

SCL MEMBER

Any school that belongs to the Society for Classical Learning (SCL) is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because SCL requires adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Overall Classification: CLASSICAL

Executive Summary

Oak Grove Christian Academy (NC 27932) presents a classical-Christian orientation with explicit emphasis on a Trivium-based curriculum, Christian theological grounding, and parent partnership within a hybrid schooling model. Public-facing materials describe a classically-minded program that centers on grammar, logic, and rhetoric, with explicit attention to virtue, character, and the formation of the whole person within a Christ-centered worldview. Evidence from the school's site shows a deliberate Christian framing (Christ-centered values, theology-informed formation) and a pedagogy that blends traditional classical elements (grammar/logic/rhetoric, memory work) with a hybrid home-school component and parent partnership. While the program emphasizes important classical markers (grammar/logic/rhetoric, history integration, virtue formation, and a living Christianity in daily practice), explicit mentions of Great Books, a formal Great Conversation, and a sustained Socratic high-school pedagogy are less clear in the public materials. Overall, the school aligns strongly with classical aims and Christian formation, falling into the CLASSICAL category with some room for expansion into certain classical touchstones (e.g., explicit Great Books emphasis, broader Socratic-seminar pedagogy) to reach a fully classical standard across all six categories.

Key highlights from materials: - Classical framework stated explicitly; "classically minded" and a focus on the Trivium (grammar, logic, rhetoric) are described on the site. - Christian/theological commitments are central (non-denominational Christian grounding; Christ-centered education; theology integrated into the education approach). - Pedagogical elements referenced include memory work, chanting, and a rest-and-repetition rhythm in lower grades, with more advanced dialogue-like inquiry in upper grades (Socratic/seminal discussion patterns are implied via classical practice rather than explicitly described in every public page). - Family/parent partnership and hybrid schooling model are emphasized (parents as partners, home education components, and shared leadership in the educational process).

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The school describes itself as Christ-centered and grounded in Christian formation, including explicit statements about Christ-centered leadership and a worldview anchored in Christ. - Non-denominational Christian framing and a faith-based education approach are referenced in program descriptions. - Public materials emphasize virtue and character formation within a Christian framework (virtue-focused language; formation through a Christian worldview).

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive: Christ-centered, theology, virtue, character, formation, wonder, sacred, sacred truth, Lord/Christ-centered worldview. The lexicon includes explicit positives for theology, virtue, wonder, and liturgical practice. The site consistently uses Christ-centered language and a

Christian worldview, aligning with Positive keywords like virtue, formation, and theology. - Negative: No explicit secular or value-neutral framing; no evidence of secular-humanist tendencies in public materials.

Why this rating - Strong alignment with a religious/metaphysical foundation: explicit Christian framing and virtue-centered formation, with a clear grounding in a theologically informed worldview. The presence of Christ-centered language and a faith-based curriculum supports CLASSICAL in this category.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Public content emphasizes formation of virtue and character within a classical frame and a Christ-centered worldview (formation over mere information; cultivation of virtue and wisdom). - Language highlights the goal of forming independent, thoughtful thinkers grounded in a Christian worldview, rather than a primary emphasis on job preparation. - The sequence of the Trivium in the program (grammar, logic, rhetoric) and the intentional focus on the “whole person” point to formation and the real pursuit of truth, goodness, and beauty.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive: formation, virtue, wisdom, true/good/beautiful (within the broader classical lexicon), contemplation, wonder, Logos, sacred tradition, divine order, Christian worldview. The site demonstrates formation and virtue language in conjunction with Christian worldview and classical aims. - Negative: No clear focus on career readiness or 21st-century job skills in the public-facing purpose statements; the emphasis remains formation-centered.

Why this rating - The school foregrounds formation, virtue, and human flourishing within a classical-Christian frame, aligning with the CLASSICAL category for purpose and goal. The emphasis on formation over solely information-based work supports this rating.

Element 3: School Curriculum — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence - The program explicitly uses the Trivium (Grammar, Logic, Rhetoric) and includes specific subject areas (Latin, literature, logic, rhetoric, history, math) with a classical structure. This is visible in the “CLASSICAL EDUCATION METHOD” and “SCHOOL MODEL” sections. - History is studied as part of the curriculum (history included in subject areas; not necessarily framed as “social studies” exclusively). - There is a stated emphasis on memory work and chant (classical pedagogy elements), as well as a strong focus on classical methods, though explicit mention of “Great Books” or a formalized “Great Conversation” is less evident in the public Edenton content, with some references appearing in broader classical-pedagogy materials.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive: grammar, logic, rhetoric; history; Latin; great conversation / great books (present in broader materials, with some explicit references on other pages); wonder; classical pedagogy; memory work. Evidence of grammar/logic/rhetoric and history integration appears in the public content. - Negative: Great Books/Great Conversation are not consistently foregrounded in all public Edenton pages; the explicit Great Books references are more evident in broader classical messaging rather than every page. The presence of “Great Books” is not consistently explicit on the Edenton site, which tempers a fully explicit Great Books emphasis.

Why this rating - The curriculum clearly incorporates core classical elements (Trivium) and a history/language focus, with some additional classical features foregrounded in other public materials. However, the explicit, sustained emphasis on Great Books and a fully articulated Great Conversation appears less uniformly documented in the Edenton site, nudging this category toward SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rather than fully CLASSICAL.

Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence - The program describes memory work, chanting, and recitation as part of lower-grade pedagogy, which aligns with classical pedagogy. The presence of a Trivium-based approach implies an emphasis on structured, disciplined pedagogy including logic and rhetoric in later grades. - There are references to restfulness and contemplation within classical education (Scholé concepts) and to Socratic/seminar-like

discussion in upper levels as part of classical practice, though explicit high-school Socratic seminars are not exhaustively documented in the public Edenton pages. - The hybrid model foregrounds parental involvement and structured progression through the grammar/logic/rhetoric phases.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive: socratic/seminar, narration/recitation, chanting/memory work, scholé (restful learning), rhetoric, debate, upper-school rhetoric practice. The site shows strong classical pedagogy elements (grammar/logic/rhetoric and memory work). - Negative: experiential learning emphasis or project-based-only approaches are not foregrounded; the site does not emphasize a fully student-led, constructivist, or non-traditional instruction as a primary mode. The publicly visible pedagogy remains rooted in classical methods rather than modern constructivist models.

Why this rating - The program exhibits core classical pedagogy (memory/recitation, Trivium-based structure, rising to rhetoric/seminar activity in higher grades) but public materials do not consistently present a fully developed, high-school-level Socratic seminar culture or a universal “great books” conversation across all grades. This places it in SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rather than CLASSICAL.

Element 5: Faculty — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Public messaging positions teachers as mentors and living curriculum within a classical framework (Christ-centered formation, character formation, and mentoring are emphasized in values and mission language). The materials discuss teachers as guides and “living curriculum” in the broader classical tradition. - The school describes a teacher-centered, mentorship-forward approach (central to classical education’s living curriculum). The hybrid model also relies on faculty leadership in both in-school and home settings.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive: living curriculum, mentors, masters, teachers as exemplars, character formation, virtuous leadership, professional formation. The site uses language consistent with classical faculty ideals (mentors, Christ-centered formation, and a community of learners). - Negative: No explicit “faculty as students” or non-classical faculty descriptors; no strong negative signals in the public materials.

Why this rating - The site’s framing of teachers as mentors and living curriculum aligns with classical conventions for the faculty category, supporting CLASSICAL. The emphasis on virtue, mentorship, and a teacher-centered living curriculum is consistent with classical expectations for faculty.

Element 6: Parents & Community — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The school emphasizes a partnership with families, with parents acting as co-educators and facilitators in the hybrid model. This is a core element of classical education’s community and family formation. - There are explicit statements about parent education and formation (parent education, by-laws, and open campus accessibility). The hybrid model positions parents as essential participants in the educational process. - The school highlights inclusive community practices and a family-centered approach, reinforcing classical lineage through parental involvement and shared mission.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive: partnership with families, co-teachers, parent formation, family involvement, home-school hybrid, open campus, parent education, parental leadership. These terms align closely with the Positive Keyword indicators for Parents & Community in the Six Elements lexicon. - Negative: No explicit signals suggesting parent disengagement; the public content strongly favors active parental involvement.

Why this rating - The school’s explicit emphasis on parent partnership, co-educators, and parent education within a hybrid model strongly supports CLASSICAL in this category. Public materials consistently position parents as essential participants in the educational ecosystem.

Aggregate Assessment

- Element 1: CLASSICAL
- Element 2: CLASSICAL
- Element 3: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

- Element 4: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL
- Element 5: CLASSICAL
- Element 6: CLASSICAL

Overall Classification: CLASSICAL

Observations and nuances - The school demonstrates a robust classical-Christian orientation, with explicit Trivium-based curriculum elements and a strong emphasis on virtue and formation within a Christ-centered framework. The public-facing materials indicate a classroom culture oriented toward classical memory work, Latin/logic/rhetoric, and a strong parental partnership. While the program exhibits many core classical markers, some elements—most notably an explicit, comprehensive Great Books/Great Conversation emphasis and a fully articulated high-school Socratic seminar culture—are less visible in the public content, which supports a SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rating for two categories and prevents a perfect CLASSICAL rating across all six categories. This leads to an overall CLASSICAL assessment, with room for deeper documentation or expansion in Great Books and high-school Socratic pedagogy to reach full classical status in every dimension.

What Would Move the Needle (only applicable for SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL schools) - For Element 3 (Curriculum): Explicitly foreground Great Books and a formal Great Conversation across more grades; increase direct references to primary sources and canonical texts beyond Latin/history. - For Element 4 (Pedagogy): Expand publicly documented Socratic seminars, seminars, and debates at upper levels; clearly articulate a sustained, high-school-level Socratic culture in the materials. - For Element 2 (Purpose & Goal): Further articulate a precise articulation of “truth, goodness, and beauty” as real, knowable absolutes within the curriculum to strengthen transcendental moorings.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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